The 15 Stages of MVPCompanion

From idea to a validated MVP – a structured, evidence-based journey.

MVPCompanion guides you through 15 connected stages – from understanding the problem and your users to a focused MVP scope, clear requirements and a plan for learning.

1. UNDERSTAND

Build on a real problem and deep user understanding.

1 Idea Brief

Capture the initial idea and motivation.

2 Problem & User

Define the problem and your primary user.

3 Market Discovery

Explore the market, alternatives and evidence of demand.

2. DEFINE

Turn insights into a clear product direction.

4 Value Proposition

Define the value for users and differentiation in the market.

5 Product Mental Model

Describe how the product works at a high level.

6 Context & Lifecycle

Map the user's context and the product lifecycle.

3. FOCUS

Identify what really matters for the MVP.

7 Core Jobs

Define and prioritize the core jobs your users need to accomplish.

8 Feature Prioritization

Derive and prioritize features from the core jobs.

9 MVP Scope

Define what is in scope for the MVP.

4. DESIGN

Make the product concrete and build the right foundation.

10 Experience

Design key user flows and experience principles.

11 Information Architecture

Structure the product and its content.

12 Data Model

Define core data objects and their relationships.

5. VALIDATE & PREPARE

Plan for learning, define boundaries and get ready to build.

13 Requirements

Define functional and non-functional requirements.

14 Learning & Boundaries

Define learning questions, technical boundaries and the MVP boundary.

15 MVP Readiness

Check completeness, ensure traceability and prepare for implementation.

Cross-Cutting Lenses

Applied in all stages to ensure a holistic and consistent MVP specification.

- **User** – Real needs and context
- **Value** – Meaningful benefits
- **Feasibility** – Technical and operational fit
- **Business** – Sustainable value creation
- **Learning** – Evidence-based decisions

Market Discovery – continuous insights into users, market, competitors and trends.

Business Model – continuous validation and refinement of the business model.

MVPCompanion | A structured approach. Clear decisions. A better MVP.

From insight to impact.